

YUNZHI (WENDY) ZHANG

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Personal Webpage: <https://wz2002.github.io/>

EDUCATION

06/2026-05/2027 (expected)

UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, BERKELEY

Berkeley, United States

- Master of Computational Social Science

08/2024-05/2026

JOHNS HOPKINS UNIVERSITY

Washington DC, United States

- Master of Global Security Studies
- Energy & Environmental Security Concentration
- GPA: 3.86

03/2021-06/2024

UNIVERSITY OF SYDNEY

Sydney, Australia

- Bachelor of Liberal Arts and Science
- Major in History; Minor in Geography

01/2023-05/2023

UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, BERKELEY

Berkeley, United States

- Semester exchange program

07/2021-08/2021

PEKING UNIVERSITY

Beijing, China

- Summer program

SKILLS

Research & Analysis:

- policy research, legislative & regulatory analysis, cross-state legislative tracking, stakeholder mapping, technical writing

Quantitative & Technical:

- R, Python, quantitative/data analysis

Applied AI:

- LLM agents, AIGC, vibe coding, rapid prototyping

Languages:

- English (fluent), Mandarin (native), Japanese (introductory)

SUMMARY

AI governance & safety policy researcher with published think-tank analysis on AI regulation and infrastructure, paired with technical fluency (R/Python, hands-on AI) and quantitative training (incoming M.A., Computational Social Science, UC Berkeley).

WORK EXPERIENCE

- Cato Institute** WASHINGTON D.C. 01/2026-04/2026
Technology and Energy Policy Research Intern
 - Contributed to four published Cato commentaries (Mar–Apr 2026), the only intern of 20 credited by name on two, with editor and research-assistant roles on the other two.
 - Market Signals Over Mandates (named contributor): researched policy responses to labor-market disruption in the AI era, building the empirical case (employment data and a 2,300-leader industry survey) for AI-assisted, skills-based hiring over rigid credential requirements.
 - Built a 50-state, 10-year legislative database underpinning Bring-Your-Own-Power (BYOP) advocacy and related bill development, cited by scholars in Congressional and state-legislative testimony to advance BYOP for AI infrastructure; bills tracked by status and statutory mechanism.
- American Legislative Exchange Council (ALEC)** ARLINGTON, VA 05/2025-08/2025
General Policy Intern
 - Co-authored a published ALEC analysis of whether AI-generated content is protected by the First Amendment, using *Garcia v. Character Technologies* and related AI-harm litigation to weigh online-safety liability against free expression.
 - Authored a research brief on federalism and AI governance, analyzing how a proposed 10-year federal moratorium on state AI regulation (H.R.1) would preempt states' authority to govern AI, and mapping legislator and industry positions.
 - Built a 50-state legislative survey (27 states, 29 measures) of K-12 classroom cell-phone policy with bill-level sourcing and a data visualization, supporting ALEC's model-policy work on student device use in schools.
 - Researched across 11 policy task forces; supported the 2025 Annual Meeting (1,000+ legislators); drafted a U.S. House committee advocacy letter for a bill that passed the House 221–196.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS-AI POLICY

- Cato Institute, Washington D.C.**
 - Research Assistance: Market Signals Over Mandates: Solving the AI Era's True Labor Crisis 04/2026
 - Edited: Derailing Data Centers Harms More than Just AI 04/2026
- American Legislative Exchange Council, Arlington, United States**
 - Co-author: Balancing Free Speech and Online Safety in the AI Era 10/2025
- Additional policy commentary (energy, regulation) at <https://wz2002.github.io/>**

LEADERSHIP AND COMMUNITY

- ONE-AGI (Nonprofit Student Organization)** 07/2025-PRESENT
Co-Founder, UC Berkeley & Johns Hopkins University
 - Co-founded a cross-campus AI organization (partner: Berkeley Emerging Technology Association), growing to ~200 members.
 - Ran 8 events (~50 attendees each), including workshops and live demos on LLM agents, AIGC, and AI-agent prototyping.
 - Facilitated discussions on AI safety, algorithmic fairness, and the societal impacts of AGI; served as a primary speaker on efficient AI workflows and real-time AI applications.
- USYD Development Society 'Education in Rural China Program'** 12/2021-01/2022
Team Leader
 - Led a 5-person team to build an animated mental-health education module, reaching 700+ underserved students in rural China.
- Community & Service:**
 - President, International Students' Association (2018–2019); 10+ years teaching children in difficult circumstances at Shaanxi Aiding Center (since 2014); 7+ years serving the homeless (food, clothing, medicine) at Yellow River Soup Kitchen, Xi'an.